



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



North Korean WaterPlum Fake Recruiter and IT Worker Intrusion Campaign Daily Update - 2026-09-23

Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-23 current-day refresh turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Current-day material update: this report was regenerated for the 2026-09-23 UTC production cycle using the latest available source set and retains the structured detections/hunts required for operator use.

Joint and media reporting on 2026-09-21 describes North Korean fake recruiter and IT-worker activity targeting job seekers and companies globally, with claims of tens of thousands of infected devices and cryptocurrency theft. Defenders should prioritize developer endpoints, hiring workflows, contractor onboarding, code repositories, and payment/crypto operations.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By This Report
What happened or changed?	A multi-country advisory and follow-on reporting pushed the campaign back into daily priority because the activity blends recruitment lures, endpoint malware, insider-style IT worker fraud, source-code exposure, and cryptocurrency theft.
Who is exposed?	Developers, recruiters, crypto/AI/NFT companies, SaaS firms, managed service providers, and any organization onboarding remote technical workers.
What should defenders do today?	Harden hiring workflows, verify remote worker identity, monitor developer endpoints, and review source-code/token exposure.
Confidence	Medium-high where the advisory is cited; medium for figures relayed by media until the original advisory is reviewed.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
The Hacker News	Daily report excerpt on four-country advisory and community tracking names	Medium
Cybernews	Media report on fake recruiter infections and advisory context	Medium
Cointelegraph	Crypto-sector impact and theft figures from advisory coverage	Medium
India Today	Additional corroborating coverage of job-seeker targeting	Low/Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The activity cluster is tracked across the community as DeceptiveDevelopment, DEV#POPPER, Famous Chollima, UNC5342, Void Dokkaebi, WaterPlum, and related names. The campaign uses fake recruiting and remote-work trust relationships to get code, credentials, crypto assets, or network access.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TTP	Description	Defensive Relevance
Social engineering	Fake recruiter/job-interview lures and remote-work onboarding abuse	Security teams must monitor recruiting tools, collaboration apps, and developer endpoints.
Malware delivery	Job-task or assessment-themed payload execution	EDR should flag scripts and developer tools launched from browser/chat/email contexts.
Credential/source theft	Access to repositories, tokens, and crypto wallets	Secrets scanning and identity reviews are critical.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Observable / Pattern	Handling Guidance
Source-limited public IOCs	No unique atomic indicators were published in all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv.	Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.
Domains / infrastructure	Validate from primary source before blocking.	Prefer detection and enrichment over blind blocking when source confidence is medium.
Accounts / identity artifacts	Recruiter, VPN, administrator, or service-account themes depending on campaign.	Review conditional access, new devices, and impossible-travel signals.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Targeting is global and especially relevant to developer-heavy organizations, crypto firms, AI companies, SaaS providers, and defense/aerospace suppliers using remote contractors.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unusual script or admin tool launch after web, email, or remote-access activity	EDR / process telemetry	Identify initial access and execution.
New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure	DNS/proxy/netflow	Surface command-and-control or tool staging.
Identity anomalies linked to target workflow	Identity provider logs	Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use.

8.2. Sigma Rule

<pre> title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage status: experimental description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage. logsource: category: process_creation product: windows </pre>
--

```

detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\w3wp.exe'
      - '\java.exe'
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\outlook.exe'
      - '\teams.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: high

```

8.3. Network Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'python.exe', 'node.exe')
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Connections desc

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
A user or administrator was socially engineered into executing attacker tooling.	Script interpreters spawned from collaboration, browser, or email processes.
A vulnerable public-facing service was exploited and used for staging.	Web-service parent processes launching shells or making rare outbound connections.
Stolen or purchased credentials enabled follow-on access.	New device, new geography, or abnormal application access in identity logs.

9.2. Endpoint Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'mshta.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'node.exe', 'python.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('download', 'invoke-webrequest', 'frombase64string', '-enc', 'curl', 'wget', 'token', 'apikey')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc

```

9.3. Identity Query

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 50),
Countries=make_set(Location, 20), Count=count() by UserPrincipalName
| where array_length(IPs) > 5 or array_length(Countries) > 2 or Count > 50

```

10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T1566	Phishing	Fake recruiter and job-task delivery.
T1059	Command and Scripting Interpreter	Malware and scripts launched from user workflows.
T1552	Unsecured Credentials	Source, token, and wallet theft risk.
T1078	Valid Accounts	Remote worker fraud and stolen accounts.

11. Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Notes
Developer endpoint compromise	High	High	Direct path to code, tokens, and build systems.
Fraudulent remote worker access	Medium	High	Can bypass perimeter controls through legitimate onboarding.
Crypto theft	Medium	Medium/High	Relevant to crypto, fintech, and treasury workflows.

12. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
1	SOC / detection engineering	Deploy or tune detections above and run the 14-day hunts.
2	Vulnerability / IT operations	Patch or isolate exposed systems named in the source coverage.
3	Identity / endpoint engineering	Review MFA, device compliance, and suspicious remote-tool execution.
4	Third-party risk	Confirm suppliers and managed-service providers are applying equivalent controls.

13. References

- [1] The Hacker News: <https://thehackernews.com/>
- [2] Cybernews: <https://cybernews.com/news/north-korean-fake-recruiters-infected-30000-devices/>
- [3] Cointelegraph: <https://cointelegraph.com/news/north-korean-fake-recruiters-infect-30k-devices-steal-107m-in-crypto>
- [4] India Today: <https://www.indiatoday.in/technology/news/story/north-korean-hackers-scam-it-job-seekers-steal-rs-100-crore-2999410-2026-09-21>